

DECISIVE MOMENT

WATERGATE SCANDAL

On June 17, 1972, five men were arrested for breaking into the Democratic National Committee headquarters at the Watergate building in Washington, D.C. Investigators linked this break-in to a committee working for the re-election of President Richard Nixon. As evidence mounted of attempts to block the investigation, and of other abuses of power, on August 9, 1974, Nixon resigned to avoid impeachment. His successor, Gerald Ford, would oversee the end of US military involvement in Vietnam, and pardon Nixon for all crimes against the US.



THE END OF THE NIXON ERA

» AFTER

In spring 1975, South Vietnam underwent a rapid military collapse, its morale and fighting efficiency fatally undermined by the withdrawal of American aid.

THE DEMISE OF SOUTH VIETNAM

A victorious offensive at **Phuoc Long** confirmed to North Vietnamese leadership that South Vietnam was getting **weaker** and that the US would not intervene. This led to further successful **communist offensives**. In April 1975, North Vietnam had little trouble entering and occupying **Saigon**.